

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

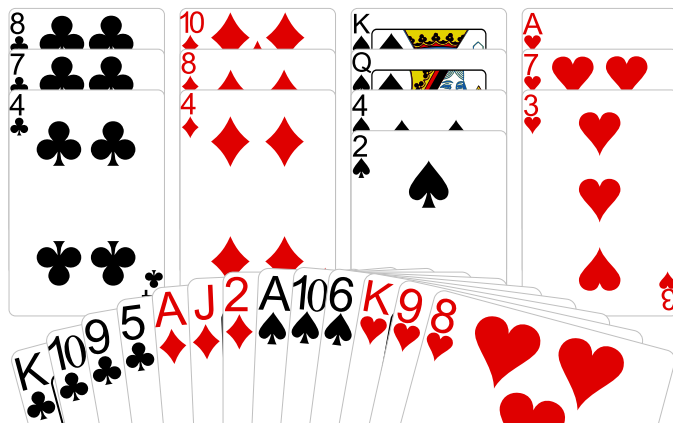
*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 5
♥ 9 5 3
♦ 7 3 2
♣ 7 6 2

17
6 8
9

♠ A 9 7 6
♥ A Q 4
♦ A J 4
♣ Q T 8



♠ T 8 4
♥ K 7 2
♦ Q 6 5
♣ K J 9 3

♠ 3 2
♥ J T 8 6
♦ K T 9 8
♣ A 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

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With 9 points SOUTH is unable to decide the final contract. If NORTH has 17 points then the partnership

should be playing 3NT. If NORTH opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So SOUTH makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells NORTH that he must make the final call - go on to

game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal NORTH has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

Deal 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 4 2
 ♥ A 7 3
 ♦ T 8 4
 ♣ 8 7 4

6
 9 15
 10

♠ 3
 ♥ 6 5 2
 ♦ K 9 7 6 5
 ♣ Q J 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 8 7 5
 ♥ Q J T 4
 ♦ Q 3
 ♣ A 2

♠ A T 6
 ♥ K 9 8
 ♦ A J 2
 ♣ K T 9 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

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This time EAST has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

WEST has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between

24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

EAST, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

Deal 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 8
♥ K 7 6
♦ T 6 5 3
♣ A T 6 4

2
11 7
20

♠ J 7 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 4 2
♣ 9 8 7 3



♠ K Q 6
♥ A J T 3
♦ A Q
♣ K J 5 2

♠ T 9 5 3
♥ Q 9 4 2
♦ K 9 8 7
♣ Q

West	North	East	South
			2NT
All Pass			
2NT by South			

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SOUTH has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution.

It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 2 points to SOUTH's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the

magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

Deal 4

South Deals
Both Vul

♠ A T 8
♥ A T 9
♦ K Q T 8
♣ K 9 7

7
16 9
8

♠ Q 9 6 5 4
♥ J 4 3
♦ A 7 6
♣ 5 2

N
W E
S

♠ J 2
♥ K 8 6 5
♦ 5 3 2
♣ A 6 4 3

♠ K 7 3
♥ Q 7 2
♦ J 9 4
♣ Q J T 8

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			Pass
All Pass			
3NT by West			

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WEST has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

EAST has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking WEST to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But WEST has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice.

In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points.

Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good"

and bids 3NT.

Deal 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 7 4 3
♥ T 9
♦ J 6 2
♣ 5 4 2

20
5 7
8

♠ K Q J
♥ A 4
♦ K Q T 8
♣ A J 7 3



♠ T 9 6 2
♥ K 7 5
♦ 9 5 4
♣ K Q 6

♠ 5
♥ Q J 8 6 3 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ T 9 8

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NORTH has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

SOUTH has 8 points. She adds NORTH's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but

nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and NORTH passes.

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North